PROJECT BATTAMBANG

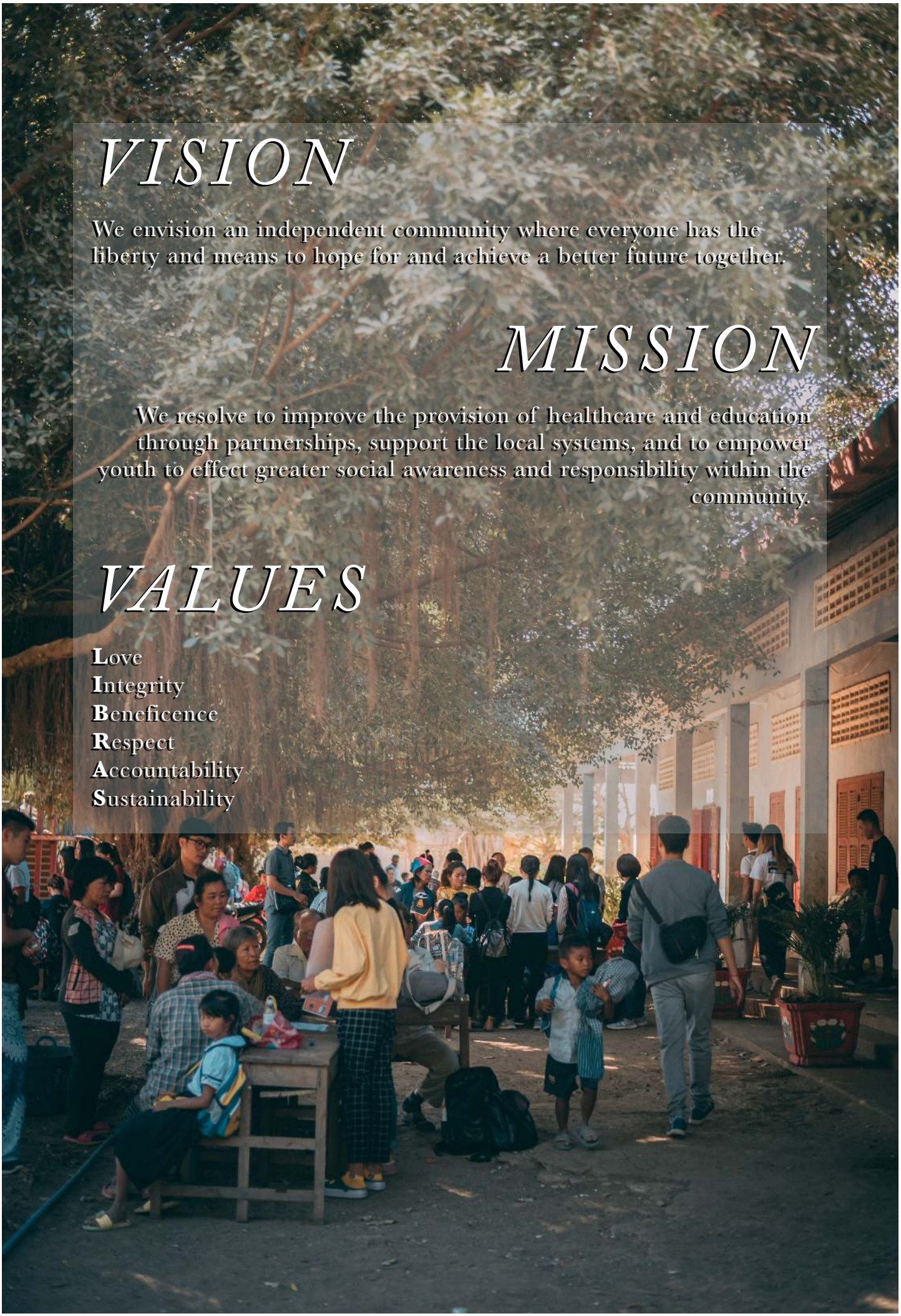
2019 POST TRIP REPORT



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VISION

We envision an independent community where everyone has the liberty and means to hope for and achieve a better future together.

MISSION

We resolve to improve the provision of healthcare and education through partnerships, support the local systems, and to empower youth to effect greater social awareness and responsibility within the community.

VALUES

Love
Integrity
Beneficence
Respect
Accountability
Sustainability




Leonard
Christopher

A WORD FROM OUR MENTORS

FOREWORD

BY DR. ONG YEW JIN & CHEA CHENG



"Dear friends and supporters of Project Battambang,

This past year has been a period of unprecedented change globally, affecting not just the routines of daily life, but livelihoods as well. For our beneficiaries in Poipet, especially those whose families relied on daily waged work across the border in Thailand, this meant a sudden loss of income as borders are closed and global demand for certain products (e.g. clothing which Cambodia is a major supplier) have plunged. This also seriously impacts the young people as their families are even less able to provide for their educational needs.

Our plans to support the villagers' healthcare needs are on hold as well due to travel restrictions. Both Singaporean and Cambodian teams, together with our partners in Poipet, have to innovate to discover creative ways of supporting our friends and beneficiaries. We hope that through this report you would see the good work the team has done, and look forward to your renewed support to join us in helping the less fortunate achieve a better future for themselves and their community. Thank you!"

- Dr Ong Yew Jin

"Our trip in 2019 provided me with many fond experiences. It was our first year in the village of Dong Aranh! I remember talking to some of the villagers, who were very happy to see all of us. Some even started to hug us like we were their family.

I would like to extend my heartfelt appreciation to all of the Singaporean and Cambodian doctors and medical students from Singapore who have spent their time tirelessly helping to grow our project, especially Doctor Ong, who has spent many years helping our people.

A big thank you to Bong Srey and Bondul from Mother of Peace Kindergarten (MOPK) as well. Both of you are invaluable members of Project Battambang. I will remember all of you as well as the beautiful sunsets at MOPK that we shared together.

I truly love everyone in Project Battambang: regardless of our nationalities, we have the same heart and desire to serve with humanity.

Finally, I would like to express my love for Project Battambang, with which even a million words is insufficient."

- Chea Cheng



"REGARDLESS OF OUR NATIONALITIES, WE HAVE THE SAME HEART AND DESIRE TO SERVE WITH HUMANITY."



DR. ONG YEW JIN

Dr Ong is a Palliative Care Physician by profession and previously the Medical Director of the Singapore Cancer Society.

Keen on serving overseas communities, he acts as the doctor Mentor for Project Battambang, guiding both the Singaporean and Cambodian teams.



CHEA CHENG

Cheng has been the Cambodian director of Project Battambang for the past three years, and has been volunteering for past five, while he was still studying. He is now a final year medical student at International University, Phnom Penh.

He often says that Project Battambang is a huge opportunity to serve those in the rural area of Poipet. His leadership, guidance and dedication to the project continues to inspire his team.

DEVELOPMENT

BY CHRISTOPHER LOW & RACHEL ONG



In our annual main trip in December 2019, Project Battambang implemented a number of new initiatives to serve the needs of the local Cambodia community. These included the expansion of screening and Health Education activities into a new village, Dong Arahn, as well as the employment of the Magpi application to facilitate data collection and processing when we went for Door-to-Door village surveys. Moreover, we also conducted door to door publicity activities, and this was conducted for our screening in Dong Arahn.

EXPANSION INTO DONG ARANH

2019 marked our first foray into the village of Dong Arahn. Having conducted screenings in the village of O'Russey Le for 10 years prior, we noticed a steady decline in turnout numbers due to improving access and more comprehensive knowledge regarding local healthcare systems. As a result, we determined that there was a decreased need for our screening services there and decided to expand into a new village.

Choosing a new village was definitely challenging, but Dong Arahn was eventually chosen from several villages following consultations with our Cambodian counterparts and local contacts. First, Dong Arahn formed the largest population of the villages surveyed - with over 670 households and 2663 people as of our 2019 recce trip. Conducting our screenings here would enable us to make full use of our resources and serve as many villagers as possible. Second, there was limited healthcare accessibility within the village. The village was only served by one health centre with limited facilities and only one small pharmacy. Hence, our screenings would bring medical care directly to the villagers and provide much needed relief. Third, our consultations with the village chief were fruitful and he was extremely keen to work with us. It was for these reasons that we were compelled to venture into Dong Arahn.

It was with both an unusual mix of trepidation and excitement that we entered Dong Arahn. But our initial queasiness was quickly quelled when we saw the turnup on screening day. Despite it being our first time in Dong Arahn, we managed to provide screening and consultations to a sizable 229 patients, of which 38 were provided referrals to other healthcare facilities. Apart from 54 chronic patients to whom medication was distributed, the most common ailments were respiratory and gastrointestinal issues.

Seeing the queue slowly fill up with villagers needing medical assistance, and patients grateful for receiving their medicines and medical advice, affirmed our decision that expanding into Dong Arahn was the right thing to do. In fact, the village chief himself personally came down for a health screening, and our committee subsequently discussed with him ways which we could better serve the village in coming years.



DATA COLLECTION

To better understand the needs of the villagers, we also conducted Door-to-Door Needs Assessment Surveys at both Dong Arahn and MOPK villages, with the help of the app Magpi. The Magpi initiative was essential in facilitating our data collection as it has a GPS function that enabled us to view the coverage of the population surveyed, as well as the general trend of the common needs of a certain district or street so as to help us troubleshoot how we can better improve our aid and outreach. Furthermore, it also gave us the flexibility of allowing multiple entries at one point of time. The entire Project Battambang committee, comprising of the Singapore committee members and Cambodian volunteers, was split into several groups to cover different districts at the same time. We were also able to use Magpi without the need of any wifi or data when completing the survey, which is a limited resource in the village. Moving forward, we are looking to the continuation of the usage of Magpi as it is a good data collection tool and has many versatile functions, in comparison to other data collection applications. The Magpi initiative was also crucial in facilitating data analysis as there are functions to generate data in a spreadsheet format for quicker analysis and trend observation. Utilising Magpi, we conducted door to door demographic surveys at the village of Dong Arahn, and the area surrounding MOPK. 56 households were surveyed in Dong Arahn, along with 69 households surrounding MOPK. Through evaluating the data, we were able to obtain information regarding their main health concerns, their individual healthcare challenges, educational issues that they desired greater knowledge about, as well as feedback on the usefulness of our services. This would enable us to better streamline further educational initiatives and address healthcare concerns in the future. The two geographic heat maps below shows how much area we have covered for our surveys.

MOPK

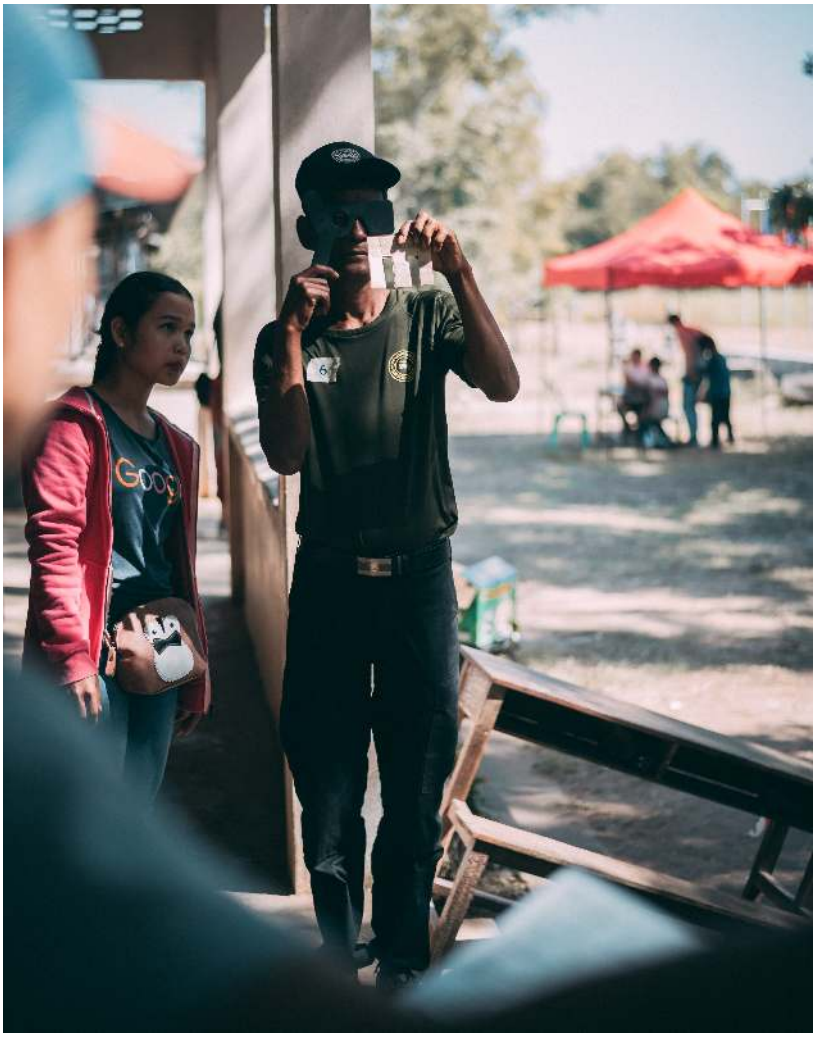
Dong Arahn



Geographic heat map of surveys conducted at the area surrounding MOPK and Dong Arahn, adapted from satellite images. Red and green represent the most and least concentrated areas of surveying respectively, with yellow being the middle of the spectrum

RENAMING

2019 was also the year that the Survey committee underwent minor restructuring and was renamed the Development committee. This was due to the some expanding responsibilities of the committee, whereby 'Survey' was not the best representation of the scope of work. The committee was not only responsible for conducting Needs Assessment Surveys, but also played a part in implementing new initiatives to set a new direction for the upcoming year's main trip. The new initiatives are a combination of both the results collected from the surveys to better tailor our aid to the villagers' needs and wants and was based on observations we made on how we could amend the running of Project Battambang as we work towards our final goal of self-sustainability and continuity and gradually transferring more responsibilities in the running of the project to the local community.



"ENSURING CONTINUITY AND SELF-SUSTAINABILITY IN THE CAMBODIAN COMMUNITY"

FUTURE DIRECTION

Keeping that in mind, the Development committee has hopes of restructuring the Cambodian committee to ensure continuity for the running of Project Battambang. This includes a structured recruitment procedure and imparting of essential skills that are specific to each committee to our Cambodian counterparts, while also guiding them to better understand how such projects are run. This would come in the form of having a volunteer, Junior and Senior Cambodian committee where Cambodian healthcare students can first join us for the first time as a volunteer to gain a new experience of volunteering with Project Battambang. If they are interested in making a greater contribution to the project, they can make the decision to join the project as a Junior committee member. Under the guidance of their Senior committee members, who have been in the project for several years, are able to teach and impart their skills and knowledge to their Junior committee members. This is in line with our hopes of ensuring continuity and self-sustainability in the Cambodian community.

EDUCATION

BY TAN JIAN SHIUN, CLARA NG, & NICOLETTE TAN

In Project Battambang, we strongly believe in the importance of education in improving universal standard of living and empowering individuals by equipping them with necessary skills and knowledge to promote self-sufficiency.

OVERVIEW

In order to achieve our overarching goal of empowering the community in Poipet, we have placed great emphasis on reaching out to the schooling youths.

We have developed a health education syllabus for children to learn basic health education from young and cultivate good hygiene habits. We also educate their parents so as to ensure that the children continue practising what they learn.enabling them to focus on restoring their health, with the generous contributions from our donors and doctors.

Through initiatives like Light-A-Dream Scholarship and School Support Programme, Project Battambang aims to empower both students and teachers.

Furthermore, our programmes such as Health Education Day and school health education aim to equip local residents with healthcare knowledge regarding common diseases and relevant preventive measures.

In order to make a greater impact, we base our education content on information from on-the-ground surveys regarding the needs of the residents. By consistently updating our syllabus, we aim to better address the needs of the community and promote more specific preventive measures to tackle common diseases that the local population faces.

LAD SCHOLARSHIP

The Light-A-Dream Scholarship is a long-standing initiative that is unique to Project Battambang. It invests in the education of a group of selected students in the hope that they will contribute back to the community in the future. These groups of students, ranging from Grades 7 through 12 and even up to university, are selected by the sisters of the "Missionary Society of the Sacred Heart of Jesus" (MSSHJ) based on their personal and financial needs and are financially supported by the scholarship.

In order to inspire scholars to make a positive impact on the Cambodian community, we also host a 2-day LADS camp annually. During this camp, we conduct workshops that impart essential life skills, values and aim to engender a sense of service.

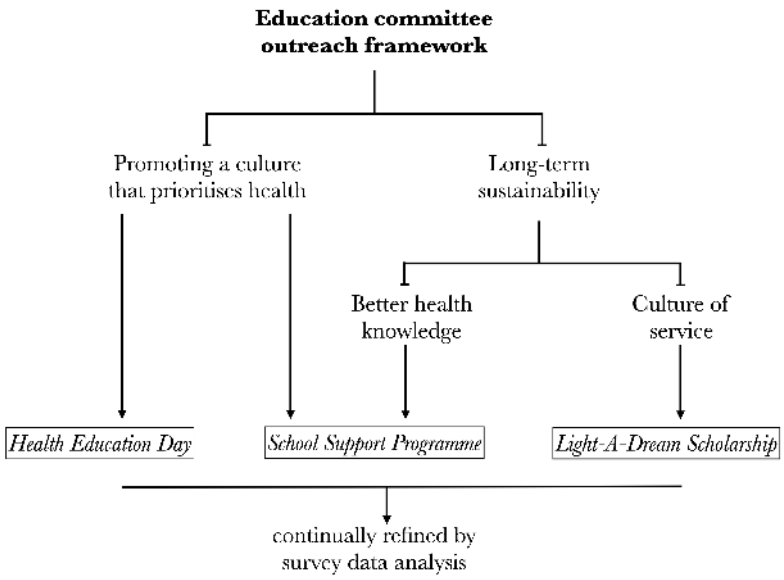
Last December, our LADS camp theme was "Leadership and Teamwork", which are essential skills in today's context. Through various engaging activities as well as sharing sessions, the scholars were taught about how to effectively lead a team using communication skills. The camp has allowed the scholars to step out of their comfort zone and build self-confidence.

We also believe that the camp is a fantastic opportunity to foster deeper bonds between the LAD scholars and Project Battambang members. We are working to develop the LADS community into a family that can act as a support network for the scholars.

Currently, our team is focusing on developing a better understanding of the scholars aspirations and goals in order to tailor our syllabus to equip the scholars with relevant skills; for instance, we intend to introduce the scholars to university application processes and resources during future camps.

SCHOOL SUPPORT PROGRAMME

During our main trip in 2018, we implemented the School Support Programme (SSP) with Santipheap Primary School, which has approximately 250 students across 6 grades. SSP is a programme that does two things: firstly, it channels funds towards improving the school's facilities in order to create a conducive environment for learning; secondly, it



"WE STRONGLY BELIEVE IN THE IMPORTANCE OF EDUCATION IN IMPROVING UNIVERSAL STANDARD OF LIVING."

aims to educate young students on health-related topics.

In 2018, our short term goals were to meet the immediate needs of Santipheap; SSP funded the construction of a well and toilets within the campus. We are pleased to report that as of the 2019 main trip, these short term goals have been accomplished and the students are now able to enjoy sanitary water and clean toilets. This would not have been possible without the help from our sponsors who provided the funds required for the construction of these facilities.

As for our long term goals, we aim to conduct lessons that address the health needs of students according to their age group; e.g. lessons about puberty to the students in grade 5 and 6. During our pilot run conducted on the 2019 main trip, we saw the children enjoy the lessons. Their positive response has been very encouraging, and we hope to continue improving the curriculum by centring the lessons around these three aspects: physical, emotional and psychological wellbeing. We will also continue strengthening our relationship with the principal and children at Santipheap.

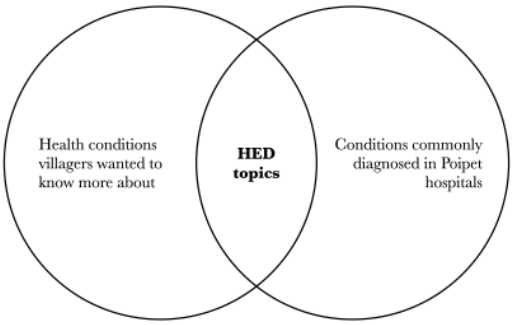
HEALTH EDUCATION DAY

Health Education Day (HED) is a relatively new initiative that was rolled out in 2017. Since its conception, it has consistently received good feedback. HED is conducted in each village before the health screenings. Through information booths and interactive games, HED aims to provide health-related information in a palatable form.

Ever since its inception, Health Education Day has been instrumental in our health outreach programmes, being the main form of health education outreach between the Battambang committee and the villagers of Poipet.



Last December, our carnival booths managed to integrate prevalent health topics such as High cholesterol, Dengue, Diabetes as well as more specific conditions such as Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease and Cataracts. The topics were handpicked based on a statistical analysis of surveys conducted, as well as hospital and village clinics admission diagnosis.





FUTURE DIRECTION

Moving forward, we fully intend to continue focusing on long-term sustainability for our health outreach system. We believe that accountability to one's health is a personal responsibility, and we hope that we may be able to encourage a culture that priorities health amongst the community in Poipet.

Additionally, we are working to provide greater structure to the LADs scholarship programme by implementing an interview process and standardised selection criteria. We uphold our belief that no misfortuned Cambodian child should be denied the right of education. As such, our selection criteria will not only value one's academic standing but will also take into consideration students who might fall through the cracks due to social or financial barriers.

Project Battambang is not a Yong Loo Lin project or a Singaporean project for that matter. Instead, our project prides itself on the mutual cooperation and shared vision between Singaporean and Cambodian medical students to ameliorate common health issues faced in impoverished Poipet villages. Moving ahead, our sub-committee aims to prioritize relations between the Singaporean committee, Cambodian committee and LADs scholars, who we hope can develop into bastions of their communities' and own health. With the advent of more telecommuting services, we aim to strengthen communication between mentioned parties to ensure all parties are updated of current community health situations as well as to monitor both the academic and social progress of our LADs scholars.

SCREENING

BY NICOLE LAU & LEONARD TEO



Project volunteers from our Co

Situated along the rural outskirts of Cambodia, Poipet is one of the poorest provinces where many villages are denied access or unable to afford healthcare services. This perpetuates as a cycle as these communities are unaware of how to get access and hence remain estranged out of their local healthcare system. Project Battambang hence hopes to reintegrate them back into their healthcare system via Screenings and our Hospital Referral Programme. In 2019, we conducted screenings at 3 villages over a course of 4 days; Dong Aranh, Mother of Peace Kindergarten, Tum Nub Kor Pram. With the collaborative effort of our Cambodian and Singaporean doctors and volunteers, we screened a total of 671 villagers. Dental clinics and education on dental care are conducted concurrently, thanks to our partnership with Cambodian dental students from University of Health service. With their expertise, we were able to provide much-needed fluoride and sealant treatment for children, as well as consult their opinion to provide more comprehensive care during health screenings.

VILLAGE/SCHOOL SCREENING AND REFERRALS

During screening, villagers were brought through various modalities to assess them for their visual acuity and presenting health conditions which ranged from tuberculosis encephalitis, thyroid pathologies and uterine prolapse to chronic conditions of diabetes and hypertension. Overall, the most commonly seen problems were Upper Respiratory Tract Infections, Cataracts and Gastrointestinal related conditions.

Conducting village screenings at Poipet has shown us first-hand the financial struggles and sacrifices that families have to make at the expense of their health. A 14 year old boy who was mentally challenged suffered from a fractured lower limb due to a road traffic accident. However, he was forcefully discharged before fully recovering due to financial inadequacies. His mother was pregnant and had 4 other children, which undoubtedly made arrangements difficult. At our screening, our doctors administered acute treatment of wound cleaning and dressing. Subsequently, we brought him to Angkor Hospital for Children (ACH) to treat his fracture. These are one of the many salient examples of how we are able to cover treatment and transport costs, thus alleviating their financial concerns and enabling them to focus on restoring their health, with the generous contributions from our donors and doctors.

Beyond Village Screenings, Project Battambang recognises the need to maintain good health and hygiene by imparting health education at a young age. We conducted School Screenings at Love Without Boundaries (LWB) and Santipheap for 163 students from Grade 1, Grade 2 and Grade 6. Some of the modalities of this two-day event included an assessment of body mass index (BMI), tests for visual acuity and colour blindness, a doctor's consultation and dental check up segment, as well as a station for the screening and removal of head lice. 44% of the students in Santipheap had height percentile of less



ambodian counterparts during our screening at Tum Nub Kor Pram

than 5, and 33.3% of the students screened had height percentile of less than 3. Upon physical examinations, skin conditions and head lice were the most common health issue presented, whereby 52% of the students screened showed signs of such conditions. Some other health conditions which were diagnosed include Congenital Glaucoma, Scoliosis, Undescended Testes, and were hence referred to *Angkor Hospital for Children (ACH)* for further treatment. In retrospect, we realised that the school children had prior knowledge on some of the topics shared during school screenings. Moving forward, we will streamline topics towards preventive measures for head lice and better care for skin conditions.

If deemed necessary by our on-site doctors, patients will be directed through our referral service to various Cambodian healthcare services such as *Poipet Referral Hospital (PRH)*, *Mongkol Borey Hospital (MBH)*, *Siem Reap Hospital* and *Phnom Penh Hospital*. Specialised pediatric cases will then be brought to *ACH*. Providing such referral services allows doctors to order more extensive tests and treatment, thereby reconnecting these villagers back to the Cambodian healthcare system. Along with dietary tips and advice on lifestyle habits, those with chronic conditions are referred to *Poipet Referral Hospital* where they are registered and added into the system so that they will be able to return for follow-up consultations and receive subsidised medications. With new partnerships formed with My Smile Dental Clinic and Ly Heng Dental, we are able to expand the range of dental services, such as fillings and scaling, provided for these villagers. In fact, nearly half of our dental referrals required advanced procedures such as Root Canal Treatments which we are now able to provide as an option for patients in need. On our trip to *Poipet Referral Hospital*, we also managed to

establish a partnership with a specialised thyroid clinic, which is a non-profit organisation. The clinic agreed to provide free thyroid screenings and tests for patients whom we referred in future.

FUTURE INITIATIVES

Chronic (Targeted) Screening

Unfortunately, with COVID-19 plaguing various countries across the globe this year, we are unable to carry on with our mid-year recce trip. As such, we are not able to take stock of the medication available for use during the next screening. This uncertainty opened up the risk of a gross underestimation or overestimation of the medication required. In response to this problem, we are looking towards implementing a targeted screening that focuses on a single prevalent health issue. The health issue can be selected based on an assessment of illnesses in the various villages visited in previous cycles, so as to target the most common illness and maximise the effectiveness of a targeted screening. With a targeted screening, we would be able to streamline our approach and purchase only the necessary medication, instead of the usual variety to prevent wastage of resources.

Comprehensive Referral Protocols

In 2019, we managed to successfully expand our base of referral partners, allowing our screening participants to reach a plethora of previously inaccessible healthcare facilities and seek more comprehensive and appropriate medical attention. However, a new problem regarding procedures that required multiple trips to the healthcare facility. For our trip in 2019, we paid the healthcare facilities upfront for the treatment needed, and provided the patient with sufficient money for transport to the facility. This left much room for the misappropriation of our project funds, should the healthcare facility deny the patient medical treatment in future trips or should the patient use the transport funds for other purposes. Therefore, we would be establishing a concrete protocol with our referral partners, through official documentation and stronger partnerships, so as to ensure financial accountability for follow-up procedures.

IDPoor

Beyond village screening, we follow up by referring patients who require further medical treatment to their local healthcare facilities. By tapping on our project funds, we pay for their transport and medical treatments so as to alleviate their financial burden from seeking proper healthcare treatment. However, to ensure the sustainability of our resources, we hope to work more closely with local health officials to effectively implement the government financial aid programme - IDPoor, in the villages of Poipet. This programme allows for tiered subsidies based on an individual's financial background and nationality, and could potentially benefit many of our patient referrals. The main obstacles that separate the villagers from this programme are accessibility and lack of knowledge about application procedures. Hence, in future trips, we will be visiting the office in charge of this programme, so as to find out more about how we can work to bring IDPoor to the villagers.

VILLAGE AND SCHOOL SCREENINGS

SCREENING LOCATIONS



Santipheap School
80 students screened

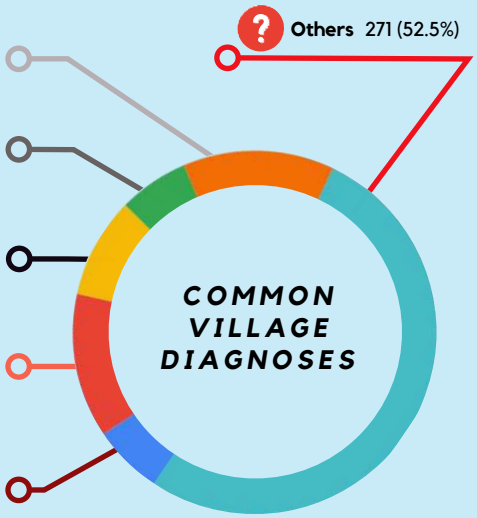
Tum Nub Kur Pram
118 villagers screened

Dong Aranh Village,
171 villagers screened

Mother of Peace Kindergarten
221 villagers screened

Love Without Boundaries School
81 students screened

COMMON VILLAGE DIAGNOSES



Blurriness of vision 69 (13.4%)
These included conditions such as cataracts, presbyopia, pterygium

Osteoarthritis 32 (6.2%)

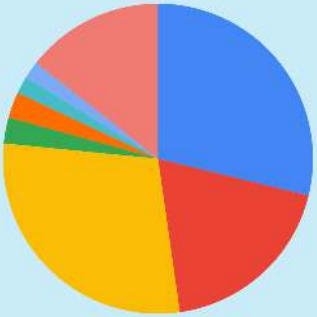
GIT related problems 46 (8.9%)

Upper Respiratory Tract infection 66 (12.8%)

Headache 32 (6.2%)

Others 271 (52.5%)

VILLAGE REFERRALS



- **Dental** 32 (28.8%)
- **Myopia** 21 (18.9%)
- **Cataracts** 32 (28.8%)
- **Tuberculosis** 3 (2.7%)
- **Ob-Gyn** 3 (2.7%)
- **Pterygium** 2 (1.8%)
- **Thyroid** 2 (1.8%)
- **Others** 16 (14.4%)

SEX

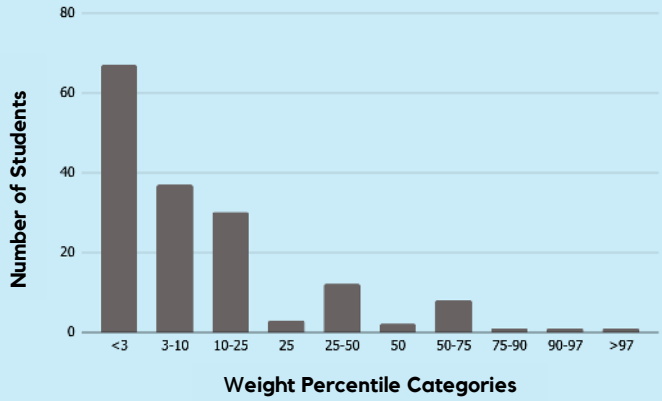


Male: 294
Female: 377

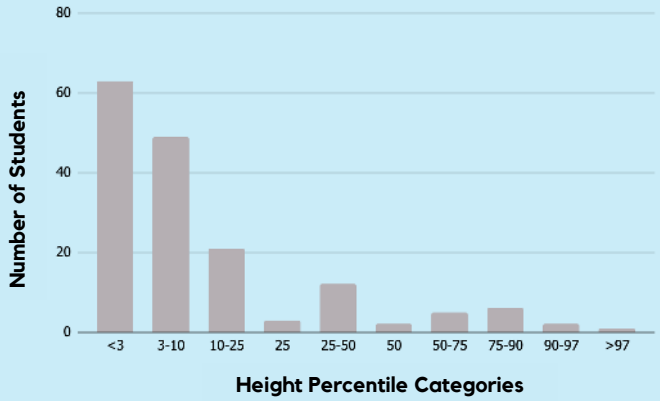
MODALITIES

- Registration
- Triage
- Visual Acuity / Ishihara
- Doctors' Consultation
- Referrals
- Pharmacy
- Hair Lice
- Post Screening Education

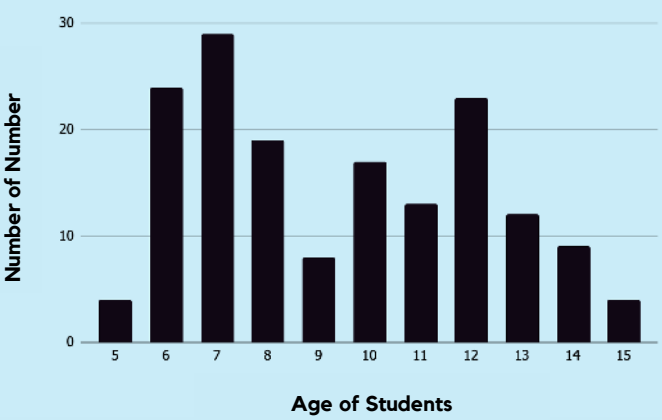
WEIGHT PERCENTILE
of students screened



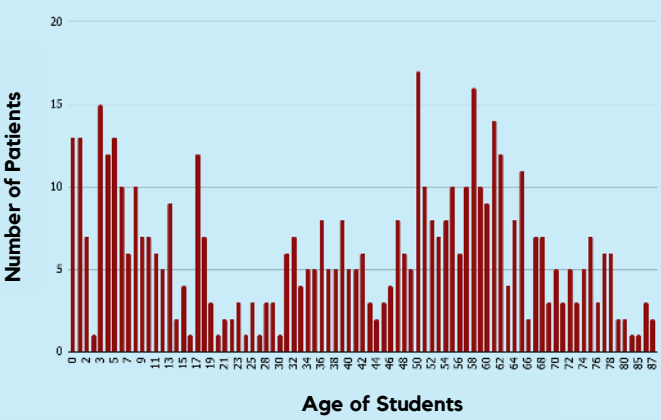
HEIGHT PERCENTILE
of students screened



CURRENT AGE
of students screened



CURRENT AGE
of villagers screened



SPONSORSHIP

BY NOAH SIM, DOMINIC YAP & ZHU XINLE



The Sponsorship Committee of Project Battambang is in charge of the publicity, management of funds and volunteer welfare. Many of our efforts take place behind the scenes, as our committee handles different responsibilities to ensure our project runs smoothly.

PUBLICITY

Part of our publicity and outreach efforts include increasing our social media presence. Through frequent updates on platforms such as Instagram and Facebook, our Cambodian and Singaporean peers are able to catch a glimpse into what we do. We aim not only to ensure our audience learn about our programmes, but also to pique their interest in our project.

In addition to online publicity, the sponsorship committee is also the team behind the Post-Trip Reports following our trips every year. (Hello there!) The Post-Trip Reports detail our progress as a project and the adaptations we have made along the way.

TREASURY

Another aspect of the sponsorship committee is treasury. During the trip, we manage the project's expenditure, such as the cost of our accommodation as well as the Light-A-Dream Scholarship (LADS). We pride ourselves in ensuring that every cent of our project funds goes towards benefiting the people of Poipet as much as possible. During the 2019 main trip, the committee sourced for the most economical options to ensure efficient distribution of our funds. One example is the change in our usual accommodation in Poipet to set up extra funds for the university students under our scholarship scheme.

VOLUNTEER WELFARE

Our Cambodian volunteers are the heart of what we do. Every year, we show our appreciation for them through events and small acts of kindness. After every week of health screenings and health education programmes, we conduct a "Volunteer Appreciation Night" to celebrate the camaraderie and friendships that we have made in the past 7 days. With scrumptious foods of different variety and mouth-watering beverages, we bond over our shared experiences, exchanging ways to keep in touch with one another despite geographical constraints.





FUTURE DIRECTION

Like many other committees in our project, the sponsorship team believes that the most effective way to ensure long-term impact would be to enable our Cambodian counterparts - as such, they are the focus of our future direction.

For example, we will be conducting marketing and research workshops so that we can support the Cambodian team as they reach out to potential Cambodian sponsors and donors.

Additionally, the Cambodian team will begin to conduct independent fundraising efforts under the guidance of the Singaporean team.

"WE PRIDE OURSELVES IN ENSURING THAT EVERY CENT OF OUR PROJECT FUNDS GOES TOWARDS BENEFITTING THE PEOPLE OF POIPET."

LOGISTICS

BY SHAYNE PEK & ISAAC YEW



The Logistics Committee' work revolves around the operation of the pharmacy during health screenings. Besides coordinating the procurement of useful medicines to be dispensed, our committee also takes responsibility for transportation and liaising with the managers of various facilities.

Despite having varied responsibilities, the principle of teamwork lies at the core of all our operations. We work closely with the other committees in Project Battambang to ensure that all the materials and equipment required for Project Battambang to run smoothly are properly and reliably acquired.

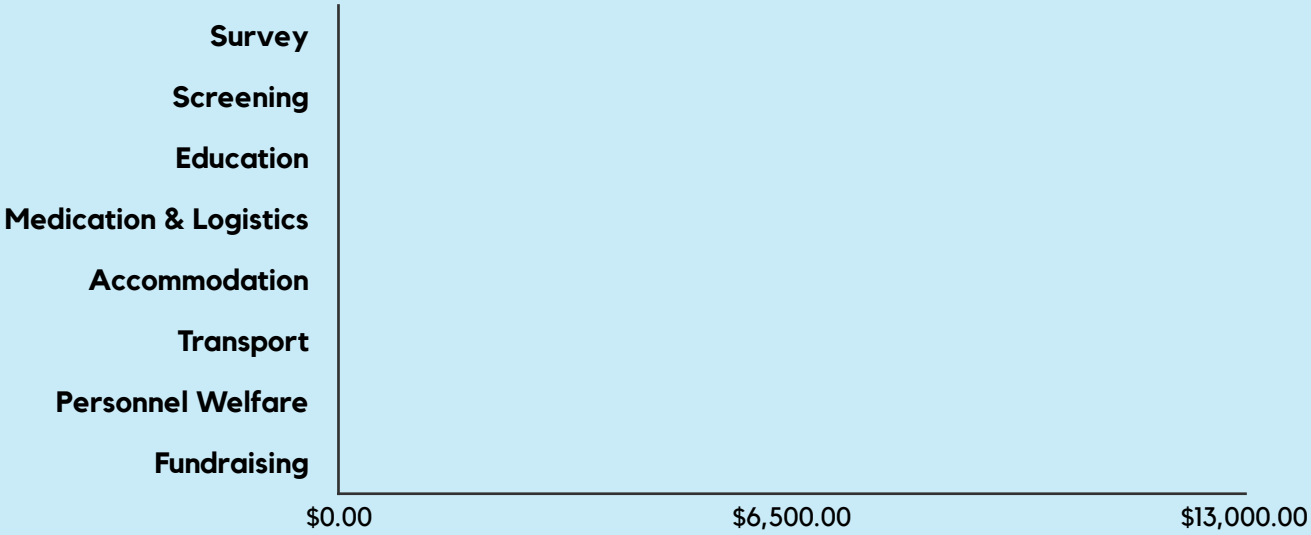
In order to develop Project Battambang as a sustainable organisation, the logistics committee has been gradually handing over more responsibility to our Cambodian counterparts. Our ultimate goal is for our Cambodian counterparts to be fully independent; we aim to accomplish this by teaching them about the roles, responsibilities, as well as practical skills. We hope to empower our Cambodian friends and inculcate a greater sense of ownership over Project Battambang.

Additionally, we are working with the Cambodian Logs Comm to find sustainable sources of medical supplies in Cambodia to supplement donations from Singaporean clinics and hospitals.

On behalf of Project Battambang, the logistics committee would also like to thank the generous organisation who have donated medical supplies or medicines to be used at our health screenings!

FINANCIAL REPORT

TOTAL EXPENDITURE: SGD$39 935.56



THE 100% PROMISE:

All donations and proceeds from our fundraising efforts were channeled into our educational and medical initiatives. Flights, food and accommodation for the Singaporean team were at our expense.

SURVEY

Logistical cost of conducting various in-depth surveys of the communities. chronic health management and environment

SCREENING

Screening Clinics
$1433.04
We buy medical and dental equipment for used in the clinics. They are provided free of charge

Referrals
$2544.21
For urgent medical attention or further investigations, we pay for medical bills, lodging and hospital transfer

EDUCATION

LAD scholarship
$8042.18
We pay for our scholars' tuition fees to allay their financial burden and conduct bi-annual camps for character building

SSP School
$3908.27
In support of Santipheap School to provide a more conductive learning environment

Health Education Day
$263.34
Various health education materials

MEDICATION

We provide medication and supplies free of charge according to the needs of the villagers

TRANSPORT

Costs include the transportation of personnel, equipment and supplies

PERSONNEL

The food and welfare of doctor volunteers and Cambodian student volunteers

ACCOMMODATION

The accommodation of the doctor volunteers and Cambodian student volunteers

FUNDRAISING

Capital spending to produce merchandise and promotional material

REFLECTIONS

BY SHANT SIN & WYMANN TANG

"The smallest act of kindness is worth more than the grandest intention."

As a fresh M1 taking his 1st step on the streets of Poipet, Cambodia, I was thrilled to embark on a journey in hopes of making a 'big change'. There is always debate over how much an OCIP can truly do for a community over a short period of time. As strangers to the community, we lacked cultural understanding and faced a language barrier.

"How then, can we make a positive change to the people of Poipet?" - this was the question that I initially struggled to find the answer to.

I vividly remember an especially helpless moment during my last trip. During our screening at MOPK, a little mute boy accompanied by his pregnant mother came in with a fractured leg with a wound dressing that started to give off a rotting stench. As I sat by the bedside holding the child down while Dr Ong was managed the wound, the child broke out into a wailing cry that broke my heart.

As we talked to his mother, we learnt about the multitude of issues she faced as a single parent. Not only did she have to support her 3 children while pregnant, but one of her children was also running a fever at the time. I deeply wished that we had been able to help the family in a greater capacity, and I was reminded of the harsh reality that the less fortunate face.

Though we were only able to offer limited management of the boy's condition, seeing the smile and expression of gratitude on the mother's face truly warmed my heart.

The experience taught me that it is ultimately our actions and support we give that puts the smile on the people we serve. To answer my initial question: we can an impact through actions of love and kindness.

I couldn't be more thankful for the dedication of the Cambodian volunteers, who acted as the crucial bridge between us and the locals. I was especially touched by Panha, a Cambodian Committee alumnus who came all the way from Phnom Penh to help us during our LADS camp over the weekend during a manpower crunch. Working with the passionate and like-minded volunteers who had genuine desire to serve inspired and motivated me to do the same during all the trips.

Even as a move on from the project, I will always be grateful for the friendships forged, and fondly remember the times we laughed. Ultimately, one of the most heartening things is seeing people from different walks of life empowering each other to achieve a common goal - and I believe- that is what makes Project Battambang so unique.



Shant Sin
19/20 Project Director

"*The View from our Couch*", is a subsection in the book, *Poor Economics*, authored by Nobel Prize winners *Banerjee and Duflo*. This section of text challenges the notion commonly held in the developed world that people in poverty face poorer health outcomes as a result of misinformation, weak beliefs and procrastination. It explains that we, living in the developed world, are no better informed individually nor are we more disciplined and decisive. The health we enjoy is largely enabled by sound structures and systems in place, ranging from sanitation systems, to credible doctors. The authors posit that individuals cannot be held entirely accountable for our health given the importance of these structural elements in our environment, and that the poor are constantly challenged by the lack of similar infrastructures.

I pondered over the sobering choice of words in the heading and remarked at how apt it was in describing the ease of falling into the trap of oversimplifying measures and solutions intended to serve communities. On hindsight, I now better appreciate the reasons why our project mentor, Dr Ong, has been continuously reminding us to seek to understand the values and priorities of the people we seek to serve before deciding on any course of action. In all honesty, despite having learnt much after three trips to Poipet, I am still not confident of claiming that I understand the people of Poipet well enough. With each trip, it seems that there is so much more to learn from them, as well as about them and their lives. They are a unique community, who are dignified and resilient amidst a challenging system and environment, yet also emanating a spirit of warmth and good-naturedness. There is a paradoxical sentiment where we are able to identify with so many of the aspirations held by the youth there, leading us to think that we are not too different at all, yet, there is also this seemingly insurmountable feeling of dispiritedness that we can never fully empathise with the challenges they face on a daily basis, or the exasperation at the lack of opportunities to accomplish their dreams.

Serving in an OCIP like Project Battambang has in many ways, challenged my thinking and helped me grow as a student. We are constantly humbled by the lessons we learn from the locals, as well as from our Cambodian counterparts from Phnom Penh.

I remember arriving at Siem Reap airport on my first trip buoyed by a naïve desire to be of help to the local community. On the first village health screening of that trip, the team was disappointed at the lower attendance rate as compared to the previous years. We attempted to find out why by conducting an impromptu survey, and discovered various reasons such as a previous NGO having conducted a similar screening just recently, a new factory set up nearby attracting many of the locals there for work during the duration of our screening, and circulating rumours about medical mishaps from previous volunteer run clinics. With the idea that screening numbers were an indicator for the amount of impact the project has had, the lower number of attendees seemed to dampen the enthusiasm we had in our course of preparation prior to the trip.

We had better luck in the next screening site we went to, and our morale seemed to take a little boost as we scurried about our respective stations to facilitate the running of the clinics. With the clinics being run in the basement of the church hosting our project, we had to remove our shoes before entering the premises. In the business of the day, the entrance to the basement was littered with footwear from both the volunteers and patients, and nobody, including myself, seemed to take notice in the hubbub of activity. That was until after escorting a patient out of the temporary pharmacy we set up, I noticed a group of children (who were accompanying their parents to the clinics), squatting by the entrance, gleefully arranging the footwear in neat pairs instead of playing at the nearby field with their peers.

It was a heartwarming to behold that despite their limited capacity, the kids were doing what they could to make things better for the people around them in that

particular instance. Looking back, perhaps we had a page to take out these children's books. We may have looked to screening numbers as an idol to pursue in order to validate the team's efforts. Instead of lamenting the limitations we had in creating greater impact, some of which were factors beyond our control, we should perhaps have appreciated more the opportunities we had to improve the lives of the patients that we did see the previous day. Despite the possibility of it just being short-term, every patient seen in our clinics had been enabled in some way - to continue doing more of what matters most to them. That in itself, is a worthy pursuit.

My second trip to Poipet was a recce trip where we sought to survey new villages as potential sites to hold our clinics in our next trip, as well as establish further local partnerships. We were accompanied by a group of 6 Cambodian students from Phnom Penh who volunteered to help us with our surveys despite their busy curriculum. In this trip, we encountered many inspiring stories of locals with the heart to serve. Two of the volunteers, Mengchrey and Sophear who were pharmacy students in their penultimate year shared with us that their dream was to start up a pharmacy in the countryside. When asked why they did not want to start their pharmacy in the city, where presumably there would be better business, they replied that they wanted to be there for those in need. A local dentist we approached to partner our project had a similar narrative to share, despite graduating with a professional degree. Despite having the opportunity to work at the capital where there are presumably higher rewards, he chose to return to his hometown of Poipet to serve his community. These accounts are in no way isolated, and my description does no justice to the amount of love our Cambodian counterparts have in caring for the community in Poipet. There is also CheaCheng, a graduating medical student whom we affectionately call "Brother Cheng", who acts as the backbone of the project, coming back every year to facilitate ground efforts with the other Cambodian volunteers. The friendship with our Cambodian friends and their infectious passion to serve has always been a key driver for the project's efforts. I also believe that it is this keen sense of camaraderie that keeps volunteers and alumni coming back

We went for our third trip as seniors with a heavy heart knowing that it was going to be our last trip, and also a little apprehension, for we would be in the position of showing our juniors the ropes in the project. We aimed to live in the little moments a little more, to appreciate the interactions with the community and the friendships forged, and perhaps to soak in a little more of the view of that sunset we always looked forward to at the end of each day from the veranda of MOPK. It was a particularly reflective trip, as we pondered about what we have managed to do the past three trips, and how our experiences have shaped us as a person and influenced our perspectives of healthcare and our future role as healthcare providers.

Change is a complex and at many times, a slow process where we may not always be present long enough to witness it happening. While various arms of the project are intentional about it and have endeavoured to enact positive change in different aspects over the years, we are still constantly in the process of learning how best to do so. Furthermore, with the limitations we have as a school project, we may not be successful each time as well. What then, describes the value of Project Battambang as an OCIP serving the community in Poipet? Beyond the numbers and milestones indicated in this report, perhaps we are just trying to prove that despite the circumstances, **there are people who care.** It is my sincere hope that the Project has in some way or another, empowered and inspired others to do the same for their community.



Wymann Tang
19/20 Project Director

SINGAPOREAN COMMITTEE

MEET THE TEAM



19/20	20/21
Alicia Chng	Christopher Low
Alys Chia	Clara Ng
Avelyn Aw	Dominic Yap
Elliott Lee	Isaac Yew
Shaun Lim	Leonard Teo
Liu Shi Yu	Noah Sim
Natalie Tan	Nicole Lau
Shant Sin	Nicolette Tan
Wymann Tang	Rachel Ong
Rachel Teng	Shayne Pek
Wesley Teo	Tan Jian Shiun
Wang Yuxing	Zhu Xinle

CAMBODIAN COMMITTEE

MEET THE TEAM



19/20

Bith Chandaravisal
Bun Sokly
BunGech Kouy
Huot Chandalin
Keo Sophina
Leng Som Nang
Lim Chanoudom
Ly Zoka
Meun Chhany
Ngeth Sokun
Monyneath
Pisey Sereypich
Sok Kimmeng
Sonsen Rithysak
Sor Cheacheng
Sum Setha
Sung Meng Kheang
Tann Lyna

20/21

An Sopheaktra
Chitra Chum
Lim Helene
Luk Chamnap
Oum Baramy
Sam Soklina
Sarin Ratha
Saroeun Sokhantey
Sor Cheacheng
Sour Sokheng
Thy Bunpaov

DOCTORS AND STUDENTS

OUR VOLUNTEERS

Cambodian Healthcare Students

Bo Sovatha
Bun Chandara
Chan Korngkeo
Chao Yofan
Chea Longmeng
Chhorn Pesey
Chorn Sreynet
Chov Sothynarith
E Samrach
Ear Muyhouy
Eung Kimteng
Heng Valine
Hon Hoksreng
Horn Sengluot
Houn Chumnith
Key MengHong
Khat Mouy Ly
Khean Mengkong
Khim Rathana
Khom Sophallika
Khorn Ratana
Khun SreyLen
Kim Kinpagnatearika
Kong Holivon
Kong Meyrong
Kry Reaksmey
Ley Soklang
Lim Helene
Liv Sivmey
Luchy Seakmey
Ly Naron
Ly Sreypov
Mang Sonita
Mean Kovputhorsma
Meng Geckhour
Narv Sreynak
Net Chan Boramey
Nhel Norak
Norng Be
Pann Huorisomnang
Phal Monyroth
Pheng Buntheng
Pheng Darech
Phom Chansreynut
Phors Vicheka
Pot Sokhour
Pouy TechSreng
Pum Songha
Rous Ravin
Sea Ralin
Sean Nitha
Seap Sophany
Seng Ramy
Sim Limsour
Sim Songchansok
Sok Hengteang
Sok Srunheang
Sok Veasna
Son Rothanak
Soung Keathour
Tang Mey E
Teng Vichheka
Tha PhimPha
Thy Chantrea
Vann Sreynich
Vann Uyeang
Virak Soka
Vuth Gichmouy
Y Sokchhay



Singaporean Doctors

Dr Anastasia Yunirakasiwi
Dr Ang Qianbo, Joseph
Dr Anne Goei Hui Yi
Dr Choi Ci En Ellie
Dr Chong Jia Ying
Dr Lee Wei Siang
Dr Liew Kok Wei
Dr Lim Zhe Zheng Clyde
Dr Ong Yew Jin
Dr Yeow Huifen

Cambodian Doctors and Nurses

Dr Ray Rayal
Veng Bondol

Singaporean Medical Students

Chia Jeng Long
Erica Lauren Soong
John Zhag Jiong Yang
Lee Wan Xin Ailica
Loh Hong Rong
Ong Yi Jing
Pong Jia Jing, Jonathan

Singaporean Pre-University Students

Jessica Halim

OUR PARTNERS



MISSIONARY SOCIETY OF THE SACRED HEART OF JESUS (MOPK)

Sisters of the MSSHJ serve poor and marginalised communities worldwide. The Sisters in Poipet aid us in overseeing our scholarship and teachers' support programmes. They also help provide overnight accommodation and food for our referral patients.

CAMBODIAN MEDICAL SCHOOLS

We are honoured to have been joined by Cambodian Medical and Dental students from the *International University of Cambodia (IU)* and the *University of Health Sciences (UHS)*.

LOVE WITHOUT BOUNDARIES (LWB)

Love Without Boundaries is an authentic international charity that provides hope and healing to orphaned and vulnerable children, and their underserved communities, through its education, nutrition, medical, and foster care programs.

SEVA FOUNDATION

SEVA is a non profit charitable organisation that aims to improve quality and accessibility of eye care services in marginalised communities around the globe to ensure the power of sight is within everyone's reach.

OUR

Project Battambang would not have been able to continue serving the people of Poipet without valuable contributions from these individuals, in terms of monetary, logistical or pharmaceutical support.

We would like to thank each and every one of our sponsors from the bottom of our hearts.



SPONSORS



Billy Yang

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Designed by
Dominic Yap, Noah Sim, Zhu Xinle